

PETER F. KITLAS
Assistant Professor of History
American University of Beirut

EDUCATION

2014-2021	Ph.D. Near Eastern Studies (M.A. 2016)	Princeton University
2012-2014	M.A. Middle Eastern Studies	University of Michigan
2005-2009	B.A. Religion	Dartmouth College

PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

2024-present	Assist. Professor, <i>Dept. of History & Archaeology</i>	American U. of Beirut
2022-2024	Postdoc, <i>Center for the Study of the Arab World</i>	NYU Abu Dhabi
2021-2022	Postdoc, <i>Fox Center for Humanistic Inquiry</i>	Emory University
2021	Lecturer and Postgraduate Research Associate	Princeton University

PUBLICATIONS

MONOGRAPH IN PROGRESS

Beyond the Consulate: Moroccan Scribes and Diplomatic Debates in the Eighteenth-Century Mediterranean, expected submission for review at UPenn Press Summer 2027.

PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES

- “The Eighteenth-Century Ottoman-Moroccan *Maghrib*: Mediterranean Perspectives of a Ragusan Dragoman” in *Journal of the Ottoman and Turkish Studies Association* 11, no. 1 (2024): 57-80.
- “Dialects of Diplomacy in 18th-century Morocco: Middle Arabic in the Correspondence of Ambassador Ahmad al-Ghazzāl,” co-authored with Mike Turner in *The Journal of North African Studies* 29, no. 6, (2024): 1016-1051.
- “‘Our Sultan must preserve his religion, just as you preserve your own’: Al-Ghazzāl and the Re-forging of Islamic Diplomacy in Eighteenth-century Morocco” in *The Journal of Early Modern History*, 27 (2023): 526-553.
- “Introduction to special section: ‘*Jazīrat al-Maghrib*’: North Africa as an island?” *The Journal of North African Studies* 24, no. 5, (2019): 713-716 and served as editor to special section.
- “Al-Miknāsī’s Mediterranean Mission: Negotiating Moroccan Temporal and Spiritual Sovereignty in the Late Eighteenth Century.” *Mediterranean Studies Journal* 23, no. 2, (2015): 170-194.

PEER REVIEWED BOOK CHAPTERS

- “A Scribe’s Realm: Islamic Ideals of Treaty Making and Negotiation in the Eighteenth-Century Ottoman Empire” in *A History of Diplomacy, Spatiality and Islamic Ideals*, ed. Malika Dekkiche. (Routledge: 2024): 135-162.

ENCYCLOPEDIA ENTRIES

- “Mawlāy Ismā‘īl b. Al-Sharīf Abū al-Naṣr (r. 1082-1139/1672-1727).” In *Encyclopedia of Islam, Three*. Edited by Gudrun Krämer. 3rd ed. Leiden: Brill, 2020.
- “Mawlāy al-Rashīd b. al-Sharīf b. ‘Alī b. Muḥammad b. ‘Alī (r. 1069-82/1659–72).” In *Encyclopedia of Islam, Three*. Edited by Gudrun Krämer. 3rd ed. Leiden: Brill, 2020.

BOOK REVIEWS

- Review of *Beyond Orientalism: Ahmad Ibn Qāsim al-Hajarī Between Europe and North Africa*, by Oumelbanine Zhiri, *Mediterranean Studies* 32, no. 2, (2024): 263-265.
- Review of *Arabic Disclosures: The Postcolonial Autobiographical Atlas*, by Muhsin J. Al-Musawi, *Journal of Islamic Studies* 35, no. 1, (2024): 137-139.
- Review of *Crossing the strait: Morocco, Gibraltar and Great Britain in the 18th and 19th centuries*, by James A.O.C. Brown, *The Journal of North African Studies* 22, no. 5, (2017): 910-911.

AWARDS AND HONORS

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| 2023 | American Institute for Maghrib Studies, Research Fellowship in Tunisia. |
| 2021 | Bayard and Cleveland Dodge Memorial Prize for Ph.D. Dissertation, Princeton U. |
| 2020-2021 | Dean's Completion Fellowship, Princeton U. |
| 2020-2021 | Religion & Public Life Workshop, Center for the Study of Religion, Princeton U. |
| 2019-2020 | Graduate Student Fellow at Center for Digital Humanities, Princeton U. |
| 2019 | Princeton Institute for International & Regional Studies (PIIRS) research grant in Gibraltar, U.K. and Dubrovnik, Croatia. |
| 2017-2018 | Fulbright-Hays: Doctoral Dissertation Research Abroad in Morocco and Turkey. |
| 2017-2018 | Social Science Research Council: International Dissertation Research Fellowship in Morocco and Turkey. |
| 2017 | Princeton Hyde Fellowship for research at the John Rylands Library, Manchester, U.K. |
| 2015 & 2016 | PIIRS summer language grants for Turkish and Ottoman Turkish. |
| 2013 | Rackham Graduate School research grant in Morocco, University of Michigan. |
| 2012-2013 | Foreign Language and Area Studies Fellowship, University of Michigan. |

INVITED LECTURES

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| 2024 | "Maghariba across the Maghrib", <i>Nadwa Hybrid Seminars</i> , Dar Ben Gacem, Tunis, Tunisia. |
| 2024 | "Scribal Spaces and Diplomatic Knowledge Production in the Eighteenth-century Mediterranean," Tokyo School of Foreign Studies, Tokyo, Japan. |
| 2022 | "A Teacher Writing to their Student: Language Learning in 18 th Century Morocco." Columbia University, New York. |
| 2022 | "ArcGIS Story Maps and Public History." University of Edinburgh, U.K. |
| 2018 | "For the Sake of Humanity? Diplomatic Knowledge Production in 18 th Century Morocco and the Ottoman Empire." Koç University, Istanbul. |
| 2017 | "Diplomatic Spaces in the Early Modern Mediterranean: Morocco and the Ottoman Empire." Al Akhawayn University in Ifrane, Morocco. |

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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| 2024 | "Approaching a trans-Maghrib Society in the Eighteenth-century?" <i>Before the Nation Diversity and Identity in Pre-Modern Tunisia/Ifriqiya and North Africa (12th - 18th Centuries)</i> , Tunis, Tunisia. |
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- 2024 “Scribal Spaces and Diplomatic Knowledge Production in the Eighteenth-century Mediterranean,” *Spaces of Familiarity Spaces of Difference in the Mediterranean*, Academia Sinica, Taipei, Taiwan.
- 2023 “From Tercüman in North Africa to Consuls in Istanbul: Triangulating Imperial Knowledge Production across the 18th-century Mediterranean,” MESA, Montreal.
- 2023 “What al-Miknāsī’s *maqāmāt* tell us about 18th century Moroccan diplomatic culture,” *Adab in Hebrew and (Judeo) Arabic: Poetry, Philology, Theology*, NYU Abu Dhabi
- 2022 “Reacting to Franz von Dombay: Language Learning and Indirect Diplomacy in Eighteenth-Century Morocco,” *Diplomacia Indirecta: Contactos entre Imperios mas alla de la corte*, Instituto de Historia CSIC, Madrid.
- 2022 “Governing Tangier Across the Straits in the Eighteenth Century,” *An Aqueous Bridge: People and Objects in Motion in the Western Mediterranean, from the Medieval to the Modern Eras*, Tangier American Legation Institute for Moroccan Studies, Tangier.
- 2022 “A Scribe’s Realm: Islamic ideals of treaty making and negotiation in the eighteenth-century Ottoman Empire,” *A World of Realms: A Long View of Diplomacy and Spatiality in the Premodern Islamicate World*, University of Antwerp.
- 2022 “What was European about Diplomacy in the Ottoman Empire?” *Europe and Beyond Seminar*, Emory University, GA.
- 2022 “Diplomacy’s Sacred Space in the Eighteenth-Century Mediterranean,” Mediterranean Seminar, Fresno State University, CA
- 2021 “Friendship, Justice, and Objectivity in 18th Century Islamic Diplomacy,” Fox Center for Humanistic Inquiry, Emory University.
- 2021 “Ottoman Ambassadors in Morocco: Islam and Diplomacy in the 18th Century Mediterranean,” Mid-Atlantic Ottoman Studies Workshop, NYU.
- 2021 “A Ship-ful of Scribes: Ahmed Resmi Efendi and an Ottoman Model for Diplomatic Reform,” Religion and Public Life Seminar, Princeton U.
- 2020 “What is Moroccan about 18th century Diplomacy?” Middle East Studies Association (MESA).
- 2019 “Ragusa in the Middle?: Exploring 18th century diplomatic relations between Morocco and the Ottoman Empire,” MESA.
- 2019 “Islamic Humanism and the Transition to Modern Diplomacy in Morocco and the Ottoman Empire,” Institute of Islamic Studies, McGill University.
- 2017 “Mediterranean Diplomatic Nodes: Uncovering Social Spaces of Early Modern Muslim Ambassadors,” ACLA, Utrecht, Netherlands.
- 2016 “*Bilad al-Sudan* in Maliki Legal Texts,” MESA.
- 2015 “Infra-Islamic Diplomacy: A Case Study of two Moroccan Ambassadors in Istanbul,” MESA.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026	The Ottoman Arab Provinces 1516-1798	American Univ. of Beirut
2026	Medieval North Africa and al-Andalus	American Univ. of Beirut
2025	Travel Writing and History Making (Ph.D./MA)	American Univ. of Beirut
2025	Colonial North Africa, 1830-1962	American Univ. of Beirut

2025	Advanced Historical Interpretation (Ph.D./MA)	American Univ. of Beirut
2025	Mediterranean Empires to 1800	American Univ. of Beirut
2024	Medieval North Africa and al-Andalus	American Univ. of Beirut
2024	The Ottoman Arab Provinces 1516-1798	American Univ. of Beirut
2023	The Making of the Muslim Middle East (Instr.)	NYU Abu Dhabi
2022	Friendship and Islam: From Rumi to Ramy (Instr.)	Emory University
2021	The Clash of Civilizations? (Co-Instructor)	Princeton University
2019	Muslims and the Qur'an (Section Instructor)	Princeton University
2019	Islam in America (Head Instructor)	The Lawrenceville School
2014	Introduction to Arab Culture (Section Instructor)	University of Michigan
2009-2011	English and Youth Leadership (Instructor)	Ribat El Kheir, Morocco
2008-2009	Patterns of Religious Experience (Section Inst.)	Dartmouth College

TEACHING DEVELOPMENT

2022	Faculty Research Mentor for NYU Abu Dhabi undergraduate research project on the "Global History of Abu Dhabi"
2019	Teaching Transcript at the McGraw Center for Teaching and Learning. (Princeton University)
2016-2017	Cotsen Junior Fellow. Developed new course syllabi and material for Near Eastern Studies. (Princeton University)
2014	Research Assistant developing new content and syllabus for "Introduction to Arab Culture." (University of Michigan)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2026-Present	Individual Member, Board of Directors, American Institute for Maghrib Studies
2025-Present	Board Member, General Education Committee, AUB
2025-Present	Coordinator, AIMS Alumni Association
2025	Member, Program Committee for MESA 2025 Annual Conference
2024-Present	Member, Undergraduate Student Academic Affairs Committee, AUB
2023	Convener, <i>Thinking in the Multiverse: The Many Layers of Islamic Diplomatic History</i> , NYU Abu Dhabi.
2019-Present	Bulletin Editor, Spain/North Africa Project, spainnorthafricaproject.org .
2019-2020	President, Grad Student Caucus, Center for Digital Humanities, Princeton
2015-2016	President, North African Studies Graduate Student Group, Princeton
2016	Convener, <i>Jazirat al-Maghrib Graduate Student Symposium</i> , Princeton
2015-2016	Graduate Student Liaison, Near Eastern Studies, Princeton
2013-2014	Coordinator, Mediterranean Topographies Workshop, Michigan.
2013	Convener, <i>Mapping the Mediterranean: Space, Memory, and the Long Road to Modernity</i> .

RESEARCH LANGUAGES

Arabic (Classical, MSA, Moroccan Colloquial, and Lebanese Colloquial)
Turkish (Modern and Ottoman)
Spanish (reading, B2 speaking)
French & Italian (reading)
Farsi (Beginner)